# Jake S. Truscott, Ph.D.

Department of Political Science
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## ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

**University of Florida** (Gainesville, FL) *August 2024 - Present*
Department of Political Science
Assistant Professor

**Purdue University** (West Lafayette, IN) *July 2023 - June 2024*
**Center for C-SPAN Scholarship & Engagement**
Postdoctoral Research Associate
Inaugural Appointee

## EDUCATION

**University of Georgia** (Athens, GA) *August 2018 - May 2023*
Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D) in Political Science
Major Focus: American Politics
Minor Focus: Formal Theory

**University of Nevada, Reno** (Reno, NV) *August 2015-May 2018*
Dual Bachelor of Arts (B.A)
Major (1): Political Science
Major (2): International Affairs (Specialization: Law, Diplomacy, and Organization)

**George Mason University** (Arlington, VA) *Fall 2016*
Semester Exchange Program (The Fund for American Studies)
Internship: The United States Supreme Court, Office of the Clerk of Court

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Judicial Politics, Processes, and Behaviors; American Institutions; Computational Social Science; Text-as-Data; Machine Learning; Models of Spatial Voting

## TEACHING INTERESTS

Judicial Politics and Behavior, American Institutions, Constitutional Law, Criminal Justice Administration, Research Design, Research Methods, Computational Social Science (Data Analysis and Visualization, Text as Data, Natural Language Processing, and Machine Learning).

## PUBLICATIONS

### Peer Reviewed

2026 Truscott, J. S., & Romano, M. K. (2026). Measuring Judicial Ideology Through Text. *Journal of Law and Courts*, 14(1), 65-82.

2025 Ornstein, J. T., Blasingame, E. N., & Truscott, J. S. (2025). How to Train Your Stochastic Parrot: Large language Models for Political Texts. *Political Science Research and Methods*, 13(2), 264–281.

..... Award: Gosnell Prize for Excellence in Political Methodology (2022)

2024 Truscott, J. S. (2024). A Social Media Platform Model of Supreme Court News. *Political Research Quarterly*, 77(3), 866-879.

Truscott, J. S. (2024). Analyzing the Rhetoric of Supreme Court Confirmation Hearings. *Journal of Law and Courts*, 12(1), 45–66.

..... Award: Best Article Published in the Journal of Law & Courts (2025)

2022 Truscott, J. S. (2022). The Supreme Spectacle: An Analysis of Public Attendance at the Supreme Court. *Justice System Journal*, 43(3), 470–481.

### Book Chapters

2023 Truscott, J. S., & Wilhelm, T. (2023). Explaining Congressional Support for the Federal Judiciary. In *Research Handbook on Law and Political Systems* (pp. 122-138). Edward Elgar Publishing.

### Newsletters, Notes, and Misc.

2026 Truscott, J. S., & Romano, M. K. (2026). Text and Judicial Ideology. *Law & Courts Newsletter*, 36(1), 4–16.

### R Packages




`scotustext(R)`: Automated tools to retrieve, parse, clean, and analyze documents from the United States Supreme Court, including: oral argument transcripts, motions, applications, orders, and decisions.

## WORKS UNDER REVIEW

The Politicization of Turnover in the Lower Federal Courts (*Invited to Revise and Resubmit)*
with Dr. Richard Vining (Georgia)

Turn Up That Dissent: A Theory and Empirical Examination of Supreme Court Cert Petitions' Strategic Amplification of Lower Court Dissents (Law Review)
with Dr. Adam Feldman (Legalytics, Florida State)

## WORKS IN PROGRESS

Measuring Cohesion and Divergence in the Supreme Court Opinion Space
Co-Author: Dr. Michael K. Romano (Shendandoah)

Re-Examining Amicus Curiae in an Information-Bolstering Environment
Co-Author: Dr. Adam Feldman (Legalytics, Florida State)

Predicting Coalescence in Supreme Court Oral Arguments.
with Hunter Tierman (Florida)

The Democratization of Legal Writing
Co-Authors: Dr. Michael K. Romano (Shenandoah) and Dr. Michael Salamone (Washington State)

Updating and Re-Evaluating Clark, et. al's Measure of Supreme Court Case Salience (Working Title).
Co-Authors: Dr. Benjamin Johnson (Florida Law) and Dr. Logan Strother (Purdue)

Predictions as Inference (Working Title).
Co-Authors: Dr. Benjamin Johnson (Florida Law) and Dr. Logan Strother (Purdue University)

Do Oral Arguments Influence the Language of Majority Opinions?
Co-Authors: Dr. Bryce Dietrich (Purdue) and Dr. Maya Sen (Harvard)

State Supreme Court Justice Ideology using Text as Data
Co-Authors: Dr. Michael K. Romano (Shendandoah) & Dr. David Hughes (Louisiana-Lafayette)

A Multimodal Analysis of Emotional Arousal in Supreme Court Confirmation Hearings.
Co-Author: Dr. Michael K. Romano (Shendandoah)

## OTHER CONTRIBUTIONS (MEDIA & PUBLIC FACING)

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|---|---|
| SCOTUSBlog | Truscott, J. & Feldman, A. (2026, July 1). SCOTUSBlog 2025 Term Stat Pack. |
| | Truscott, J. & Feldman, A. (2025, June 27). SCOTUSBlog 2024 Term Stat Pack. |
| | Truscott, J. & Feldman, A. (2022, July 28). Lengthier opinions and shrinking cohesion: Indications for the future of the Supreme Court. |
| EmpiricalSCOTUS | Feldman, A. & Truscott, J. (2024, July 1). 2023 Stat Review. |
| | Truscott, J. (2023, August 1). The Supreme Court: Where Everyone Knows Your Name |
| Red & Black | Drukman, J. (2020, October 23). UGA students more than twice as likely to favor Biden over Trump for president, according to survey data. |
| | Truscott, J. (2019, July 24). GUEST COLUMN: 7 things to expect from the next Democratic primary debate. |
| | Truscott, J. (2019, January 8). GUEST COLUMN: Hosting a 2020 presidential debate could offer an incredible opportunity for UGA. |

## MEDIA COVERAGE (MENTIONED OR INTERVIEWED)

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|---|---|
| CNN | Oral arguments are taking forever. Supreme Court justices have had enough. (May 24, 2026) |
| | The last best hope for Supreme Court liberals: Amy Coney Barrett. (November 8, 2024) |
| | Exclusive: The inside story of John Roberts and Trump's immunity win at the Supreme Court. (July 30, 2024) |
| WAPO | How Trump's emergencies and wins dominated the Supreme Court term. (June 29, 2025) |
| | Eight charts that explain the Supreme Court's term. (June 28, 2025) |

As Trump dominated the docket, divided Supreme Court moved boldly to the right. (July 2, 2024)

Supreme Court delivered big conservative wins, and a mixed message. (July 1, 2023)

Justice Ketanji Brown Jackson's bold debut and independent streak. (July 2, 2023)

Supreme Court's halt on student loan relief isn't end of Biden's effort. (June 30, 2023)

WSJ The 'MAGA Supreme Court' Doesn't Exist. (July 2, 2024)

John Roberts and Brett Kavanaugh Are Now the Supreme Court's Swing Votes. (July 7, 2023)

What did we learn from the latest Supreme Court term? - Opinion: Potomac Watch - WSJ Podcasts. (July 3, 2023)

AP The Supreme Court just issued its biggest rulings of the year. Here's what you need to know. (July 3, 2023)

SUPREME COURT NOTEBOOK: Gender gap persists at arguments. (April 27, 2023)

Other Fort Myers federal judge dies before facing impeachment proceedings. (*WINK News*, July 17, 2026)

Justice Jackson's birthright citizenship opinion includes Black Americans in the story of the nation's search for equality. (*New Pittsburgh Courier*, July 10, 2026)

Unpacking the Supreme Court: Why it's not just a MAGA stronghold, and how the justices really vote. (*Fox News*, August 1, 2024)

4 major takeaways from the Supreme Court's most consequential term in years. (*CBS News*, July 3, 2024)

Which circuit had the highest reversal rate? (*Reason*, July 2, 2024)

'Unabashed': Justice Jackson marks her first year on the Supreme Court unafraid to stake her own position. (*NBC News*, July 2, 2023)

Looking Back on the Supreme Court's 2022-23 Term. (*Reason*, July 1, 2023)

The Supreme Court Had A Few Surprises This Year. That Doesn't Make It Moderate. (*FiveThirtyEight*, July 7, 2023)

How John Roberts exhibited his power in the Supreme Court's biggest decisions. (*The Hill*, July 8, 2023)

A New Landscape Unfolds: Supreme Court Oral Arguments in the 2022-2023 Term. (*Empirical SCOTUS*, May 8, 2023)

Listen: Jake Truscott talks Supreme Court decisions. (*AccessWDUN*, July 5, 2022)

UGA students more than twice as likely to favor Biden over Trump for president, according to survey data. (*The Red & Black*, October 23, 2020) (Mentioned)

Too close to call: Polling conducted by UGA predicts a tight gubernatorial race. (*The Red & Black*, November 1, 2018)

## SERVICE

### University of Florida

Faculty Senate (College of Liberal Arts and Sciences) ..... 2026-Present

### Undergraduate Thesis Advisor

Kate Spallina, Graham Bernstein ..... 2025
Manya Arora ..... 2027 (Expected)

### Graduate Committees

Helena Koroshetz ..... Spring 2025 (M.A.)
Allison Winters ..... Summer 2025 (M.A., Chair)
Hunter Tierman ..... Spring 2028 (Ph.D., Expected)

### Student Organizations

Faculty Advisor, Florida Student Policy Forum ..... 2025-Present
Faculty Advisor, Univesity of Florida Moot Court ..... 2026-Present

## TEACHING

### University of Florida

POS4931: Judicial Politics ..... 2024, 2025
POS6933: Judicial Politics (Graduate) ..... 2024, 2026
POS6933: Computational Social Science (Text as Data Methods, Graduate) ..... 2026
POS4931: Supreme Court ..... 2025, 2027
POS2041: American Federal Government ..... 2025, 2026

### University of Georgia

POLS 1101: Introduction to American Government ..... Spring 2021
POLS 3600: Criminal Justice Administration ..... Fall 2021, 2022

## CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

American Political Science Association (APSA) ..... 2022, 2026
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) ..... 2021, 2022, 2025
Southern Political Science Association (SPSA) ..... 2021-2026

## INVITED TALKS

Institute for Humane Studies Law and Democracy Workshop (University of Florida) ..... 2026 Summer
Institute in Computational Social Science (University of Florida) ..... 2026
Invited Guest Lecture (Instructor: Dr. Melissa Baker), UTEP (via ZOOM) ..... 2022

## AWARDS & GRANTS

Sidney M. Robinson Memorial Scholarship ($1,500) ..... 2017
Peter Mekis Memorial Scholarship ($6,500) ..... 2018-2023
2022 Summer Research Grant, University of Georgia Graduate School ($1,500) ..... 2022
Gosnell Prize for Excellence in Political Methodology, PolMeth ..... 2022
Best Article Published in the *Journal of Law & Courts* Award ..... 2025

## REFERENCES

Dr. Richard Vining ..... rvining@uga.edu
Professor of Political Science
University of Georgia

Dr. Bryce Dietrich ..... bjdietri@purdue.edu
Associate Professor of Political Science
Purdue Univesity

Dr. Teena Wilhlem ..... twilhelm@uga.edu
Associate Professor of Political Science
Director of Graduate Studies
University of Georgia

Dr. Michael K. Romano ..... mromano@su.edu
Professor of Political Science and Chair
Shendoah University

*Additional References Available on Request*